

THE BARRA PROCESS or BARRA ROAST METHOD

I generally purchase enough unroasted beans for a season. When those run out, I attempt to acquire similar beans, but no two beans are alike. Instead of trying to adjust the roasts to make them taste similar to the previous batches, I choose to bring out the unique character of each bean, depending on the current offerings.. My idea of consistency is not the same bean and same flavor profile every season, but instead consistent quality.

Here's how I achieve this.

I have developed 5 main roasting templates that I use to decide if and how to roast each bean. Some of the templates are geared more toward larger, wetter beans, like the ones from Brazil or Mexico, while others work better with the smaller, denser beans like those from Ethiopia.

With each new batch of beans that I am considering, I start with three sample roasts, three variations of the templates. After judging those three tests, I decide if the beans are up to Cafe Barra standards. If so, I do more tests to dial in the 'recipe' that will be followed for each bean. It is in this last step that I lean heavily on instinct, paying close attention to the smell, look and taste of the beans as they are roasting while keeping careful notes on how to repeat this 'recipe'.

Science meets art meets commitment. This is the Cafe Barra method as well as the promise.